

Northwind Apparel Co.

Human Resources Policy Manual

Effective Date: January 1, 2026 | Version 3.2 | Applies to: All Full-Time and Part-Time Employees

1. Purpose and Scope

This Human Resources Policy Manual establishes the standard employment policies, benefits, and expectations for all employees of Northwind Apparel Co. ("the Company"). It applies to all full-time, part-time, and temporary employees across all Company locations, unless a specific role or location has a superseding agreement on file with HR.

2. Employment Classification

2.1 Full-Time Employees

Employees regularly scheduled to work 32 or more hours per week are classified as full-time and are eligible for the full benefits package described in Section 5.

2.2 Part-Time Employees

Employees regularly scheduled to work fewer than 32 hours per week are classified as part-time. Part-time employees are eligible for prorated paid time off but are not eligible for health insurance benefits.

2.3 Temporary and Seasonal Employees

Employees hired for a defined period not to exceed six (6) months are classified as temporary. Temporary employees are not eligible for Company benefits unless required by law.

3. Work Hours and Attendance

The standard work week is 40 hours, typically Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 5:30 PM, with a 30-minute unpaid lunch break. Department managers may approve alternative or flexible schedules on a case-by-case basis. Employees are expected to notify their manager and HR at least two (2) hours before their scheduled start time in the event of an unplanned absence.

4. Paid Time Off (PTO)

Full-time employees accrue Paid Time Off according to the schedule below. PTO accrues monthly and may be carried over up to a maximum of 40 hours into the following calendar year.

Years of Service	Annual PTO Accrual	Monthly Accrual Rate
0 – 2 years	15 days (120 hours)	10 hours/month
3 – 5 years	20 days (160 hours)	13.3 hours/month
6+ years	25 days (200 hours)	16.7 hours/month

PTO requests must be submitted through the HR portal at least five (5) business days in advance for planned absences. Requests are approved on a first-come, first-served basis within each department.

5. Health and Welfare Benefits

Full-time employees become eligible for Company-sponsored health, dental, and vision insurance on the first day of the month following 30 days of continuous employment. The Company covers 80% of the employee premium and 50% of dependent premiums for the base PPO plan. Enrollment elections are made during onboarding or during the annual Open Enrollment period each November.

6. Remote and Hybrid Work

Employees in eligible roles may work remotely up to two (2) days per week, subject to manager approval. Remote work arrangements must be documented in a signed Remote Work Agreement on file with HR. Employees are expected to remain reachable during core hours (10:00 AM – 3:00 PM local time) regardless of work location.

7. Code of Conduct

All employees are expected to act with integrity, honesty, and respect toward colleagues, customers, and partners. Violations of this Code of Conduct may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination. Examples of prohibited conduct include, but are not limited to:

- Harassment, discrimination, or retaliation of any kind.
- Falsification of Company records, timesheets, or expense reports.
- Unauthorized disclosure of confidential Company or customer information.
- Use of Company assets for personal commercial gain without written approval.

8. Leave of Absence

8.1 Family and Medical Leave

Eligible employees may take up to twelve (12) weeks of unpaid, job-protected leave per 12-month period for qualifying family or medical reasons, consistent with applicable federal and state law.

8.2 Parental Leave

The Company provides six (6) weeks of paid parental leave to eligible full-time employees following the birth, adoption, or foster placement of a child, in addition to any leave available under Section 8.1.

8.3 Bereavement Leave

Employees may take up to five (5) paid days of bereavement leave for the death of an immediate family member, and up to two (2) paid days for the death of an extended family member.

9. Termination and Resignation

Employees are asked to provide at least two (2) weeks' written notice of resignation. Final paychecks, including any accrued and unused PTO, will be issued in accordance with state law following the employee's last day of work. The Company reserves the right to terminate employment at any time, with or without cause or notice, consistent with applicable law and the employee's offer letter.

10. Policy Acknowledgment

This manual is reviewed annually and may be updated at the Company's discretion. Employees will be notified of material changes and may be required to sign a revised acknowledgment form. Questions regarding any policy in this manual should be directed to the Human Resources department at hr@northwindapparel.example.

This document is a fictitious sample created for demonstration and testing purposes only.